Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 4
♥ K 8 3
♦ K 9 5
♣ J 6 3 2

♠ J 10 9 7
♥ Q 6 5 2
♦ 10 6 4
♣ 7 5

♠ 8 2
♥ J 10 9
♦ A J 7 2
♣ Q 10 9 8

♠ K 6 5 3
♥ A 7 4
♦ Q 8 3
♣ A K 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♠J

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠J, won by dummy's ♠Q. The ♦5 is now played from dummy. What do you play?

Play the ♦2. Considering that South opened 1NT, he must have the ♦Q for this play to make sense.

So if you put on your ♦A, South will have TWO ♦ winners established. If instead you play low, then South cannot get a second ♦ trick and will have to look elsewhere for his ninth trick. As you can see, he is not going to be able to find it.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 6
♥ K 9 3
♦ A Q J 7 4
♣ K Q 7

♠ 10 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 6 3
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ 9 7 5 3
♥ Q
♦ K 10 5 2
♣ 8 6 5 4

♠ K Q J 8 2
♥ A 8 7 6 2
♦ 8
♣ A 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♦	Pass	3♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Your lead of the ♣J was won by South with the ♣A. South then played the ♥2 and you must decide whether to split your honors.

Play the ♥4, do not split your Honors.

South's bidding showed at least 5 ♥s, so assuming he holds both the ♥ A Q, it would be silly for him to finesse the ♥9 on the first trump play.

As it turns out, when you play low South calls for dummy's ♥K, East's ♥Q falls and you now have 2 trump tricks. If you had played the ♥10 you would have tossed away the setting trick.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 7
♥ J 8 6 3 2
♦ K 5 3
♣ 10 4 2

♠ J 10 6 4
♥ K
♦ 7 6 4 2
♣ K Q 7 5

♠ Q 9 8 3 2
♥ Q 4
♦ 10 9 8
♣ A 9 3

♠ A 5
♥ A 10 9 7 5
♦ A Q J
♣ J 8 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣K

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣K, and you played the ♣9 to encourage him. He continued with the ♣Q, then a small card to your ♣A. You then exit with the ♦10, taken by dummy's ♦K.

Declarer then calls for the ♥J. Do you cover with your ♥Q or not?

Play the ♥4.

North has 5 ♥s and South must have at least 5. The reason you cover an Honor is that you hope to establish a lower card in either your hand or partner's hand. But your partner has one ♥ at the most so there is no hope of establishment.

Now that you have looked at the hands aren't you glad you didn't cover?

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 10 5 ♥ Q 6 3 ♦ 8 7 4 2 ♣ J 8 5	
♠ K J 3 ♥ J 10 8 5 ♦ 10 6 ♣ 9 7 6 4		♠ 8 6 ♥ A K 7 2 ♦ 9 5 3 ♣ Q 10 3 2
	♠ Q 9 7 4 2 ♥ 9 4 ♦ A K Q J ♣ A K	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥J

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♥J, covered by dummy's ♥Q and won by East's ♥K. East wins the ♥A at the second trick and continues with a small ♥ ruffed by South.

South then plays the ♠4 from his hand. Do you play low? or play the ♠J to force dummy's ♠A?

Play the ♠3.

If South decides to finesse the ♠10 then you will still win the one ♠ trick which you are entitled to win.

However, with South holding the ♠Q it would be very logical for him to go up with the ♠A then lead back toward his ♠Q, playing East for the ♠K. If he plays this way you will get two tricks and defeat the contract.

Board 5
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 7 4 ♥ A J 10 ♦ Q J 4 ♣ Q J 10 7	
♠ 9 5 3 ♥ 9 8 7 2 ♦ 8 6 5 3 ♣ K 6	N W E S	♠ Q J 6 2 ♥ 6 5 3 ♦ 9 7 2 ♣ 5 4 3
	♠ A 10 8 ♥ K Q 4 ♦ A K 10 ♣ A 9 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♥9

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. South's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, North has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore West must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that West **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since West will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

South has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 5 ♥ Q 7 4 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ A J 9 5	
♠ 10 9 8 2 ♥ 9 6 3 2 ♦ 5 3 ♣ K Q 4	N W E S	♠ 7 6 3 ♥ K J 10 ♦ K J 9 6 ♣ 10 7 2
	♠ A Q 4 ♥ A 8 5 ♦ A Q 8 4 ♣ 8 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♠10

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠10; low cards from North and East, won by South with the ♠A.

South next plays the ♣3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣ K Q.

Play the ♣4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣Q perhaps, dummy's ♣A will take the trick and South will later play through your ♣K toward dummy's ♣ J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).

If you play low, he **MIGHT** finesse the ♣J and again establish 3 ♣ winners. But South's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣9, finessing West for the ♣10. This is because ♣ K 10 **or** ♣ Q 10 are twice as likely as ♣ K Q.

If he does play this way East will win the ♣10 and your ♣ K Q will get one more trick.